

August 13, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department
P.O. Box 100300
Columbia, SC 29202

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Violet Gerhold (MRN MUSC2521970), Claim MUSC-9D0C-2

Patient	Violet Gerhold (DOB 2017-02-25)
MRN	MUSC2521970
Member ID / Group	BCB657213008 / GRP-77365
Claim number	MUSC-9D0C-2
Date of service	2026-06-16
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$1,033.08
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-10-26

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level reconsideration on behalf of Violet Gerhold (Member ID: BCB657213008, MRN: MUSC5753947) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-9D0C-2 for services rendered on June 16, 2026, at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center in Mount Pleasant, South Carolina. The claim was denied under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115, with the payer remark stating that "documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reconsideration and payment of the denied amount of \$1,033.08.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Violet Gerhold is a nine-year-old established female patient who presented on June 16, 2026, to MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center for an outpatient visit with rendering provider Priya N. Raghavan, MD (NPI 1669504132). The encounter was billed under CPT code 99214, reflecting an office or outpatient visit for an established patient with moderate complexity medical decision-making, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9, acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified. Two units of CPT 99214 were submitted under revenue code 0510 at a billed amount of \$1,033.08. The patient's coverage under BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina Choice Plus (Group GRP-77365) was active at the time of service, with a coverage period extending through December 31, 2026.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of this claim on medical necessity grounds is not supported by the clinical circumstances of this encounter. Acute upper respiratory infection (J06.9) is a well-recognized, clinically significant diagnosis in pediatric patients that routinely warrants evaluation and management by a qualified physician. A nine-year-old child presenting with an acute upper respiratory infection requires direct assessment to rule out complications such as secondary bacterial infection, otitis media, sinusitis, or lower respiratory involvement, and to determine appropriate treatment and any necessary follow-up. The selection of CPT 99214 is consistent with the moderate complexity inherent in evaluating an acute illness in a pediatric patient, including the review of the patient's history, physical examination, and the medical decision-making required to manage or exclude complications.

The payer's reliance on RARC N115, referencing a Local Coverage Determination, does not override the clinical appropriateness of this visit. LCDs govern Medicare coverage policy and are not directly applicable to commercial plan adjudication. To the extent BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina has adopted analogous internal coverage criteria, those criteria should not categorically exclude medically necessary acute care visits for pediatric patients with active symptomatic illness. MUSC Health is prepared to submit the complete encounter documentation, including the physician's clinical notes from June 16, 2026, in support of this appeal, and requests that the payer identify with specificity any documentation deficiency so that it may be addressed promptly.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina overturn the medical necessity denial for Claim MUSC-9D0C-2, reprocess the claim in accordance with the patient's active plan benefits, and issue payment of the allowed amount of \$679.55 as determined by the plan's fee schedule. This reconsideration is being submitted in advance of the appeal deadline of October 26, 2026, through the My Insurance Manager portal as directed on the remittance advice. Should additional clinical documentation be required to complete this review, please contact MUSC Health Revenue Cycle at your earliest convenience so that records may be provided without delay.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record